The Long View

NEW WEB SHOWS TO STREAM



UNDEKHI: SEASON 2
(SonyLIV)
The first season of this gripping crime thriller ended on a kind of cliffhanger that left you biting nails at the edge of your seat. Streaming from March 4, the show returns with its stellar cast—Harsh Chhaya, Surya Sharma, Dibyendu Bhattacharya—and even darker twists and turns.



JUGAADISTAN
(Lionsgate Play)
Releasing on March 4, this campus drama seems to have all the right ingredients—politics, love, rivalries, and an incredible cast that includes Sumeet Vyas, Arjun Mathur and Parambrata Chatterjee.

MITHYA
(Zee5)
When a Hindi literature university professor (Huma Qureshi) accuses a student (Avantika Dassani) of plagiarism, she sparks a psychological battle that leads to hostilities, revelations and even a murder.



ONKAR JADHAV

CINEMA

Role **Reversal**

BOBBY DEOL, THE BRAWNY HERO OF THE NINETIES, IS PLAYING THE BAD GUY THESE DAYS—AND LOVING IT

After 25 years in Indian cinema, Bobby Deol had little idea that he could be good at being a bad guy. The opportunity to showcase his mean streak came with the Prakash Jha-helmed web series *Aashram* in which Deol plays a menacing godman running a cult. Deol, 53, continues to explore the darker shades in the gritty thriller *Love Hostel*, which recently released on ZEE5. He plays an assassin hunting for a runaway interfaith couple (Sanya Malhotra and Vikrant Massey) in the Shanker Raman-directed feature.

"I never got a chance to do such roles," says Deol of his character, Dagar. "Seeing the good and bad days in the film industry taught me a lot. The maturity you gain makes you understand different personalities. Every individual has the good and bad in them. While playing negative roles, you just let the bad in you out."

Streaming platforms have given the careers of many actors from the '90s a new lease of life. Deol saw his fortunes turn with *Class of '83* (Netflix), released in 2020. "The character (chief recruit at a police academy) was subdued and frustrated, and helped people notice my acting. People have started thinking of me in newer roles," says Deol, best known for playing the brawny hero in the mid-1990s.

After *Love Hostel*, Deol returns for the much-anticipated season two of *Aashram*, followed by *Penthouse*, an Abbas-Mustan-directed Netflix feature. He also begins shooting for crime drama *Animal* alongside Ranbir Kapoor and Anil Kapoor. "It is my very deliberate attempt to not just play the main character," Deol says. "The characters I want to play now may not have screen time, but they make an impact."

Deol is aware of the way cinema and audience tastes have evolved since his debut in 1995. "You cannot take things for granted anymore," says Deol. "You get few [good] choices and there is such amazing talent around. You have to play every character to the tee." But Deol likes the challenge. "I am enjoying this phase of my life." ■

–Suhani Singh



SHADES OF DARK
Deol as an assassin in *Love Hostel*

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